ranks with London included a proposal for a gold standard to the Hilton Young Commission, the formal author of which was M.H. Denning, the Controller of Currency in the Government of India.

The British members of the Commission arrived in India in November 1925 and the Commission started taking evidence from witnesses in Delhi, Bombay, and Calcutta. The Commission held fifty meetings in India and orally examined forty-six witnesses. Sittings in India concluded on January 8, 1926. The European witnesses favoured a 1s 6d (gold) rate whereas the Indian witnesses advocated a 1s 4d (gold) rate. Of particular value was the deposition of B.F. Madon, an Indian witness, who tendered exceptionally sound evidence in favour of a 1s 4d rate. The Commission sailed to England in February 1926, and reassembled in London on March 1, 1926. There they heard evidence till May 12, holding fifty meetings and examining seventeen witnesses. It submitted its report on July 1, 1926. In this case too, as on the Inchcape Committee, Purshotamdas was in a minority of one and laboured hard to collect and collate evidence in support of his point of view. He got no support from his Indian colleagues who were more than willing to side with the English.

Among the witnesses before the Commission was the economist Theodore Gregory, (later Sir Theodore), who with the famous Harold Laski, was a great favourite of Indian students at the London School of Economics. But Gregory belied the high hopes Purshotamdas had of him. In his written statement he favoured the 1s 4d rate but later modified his view and in his deposition supported the 1s 6d rate. Another star witness was Montagu Norman, the Governor of the Bank of England, who advocated the 1s 6d rate in 'dogmatic and didactic terms.'[10] Purshotamdas cross-examined him and though the immaculately dressed Governor with his Van Dyke beard was always courteous and correct, it was obvious that Purshotamdas's line of questioning had annoyed him.

A delegation was also deputed by the Federal Reserve Bank of the United States under the leadership of its Governor, Benjamin Strong, to depose before the Commission. Purshotamdas invited the delegation for lunch at his hotel. After the meal was over he invited the Governor for a *tête-à-tête* which Strong was pleased to accept. What Purshotamdas had to say cast such a spell on him that he stayed on till after dinner, canceling his appointment at the US embassy. When he deposed before the Commission